

#### 4.5 Rates of Change in Trigonometric Functions

##### (1) Average Rate of Change

$$\text{Average Rate of Change} = \frac{f(x_2) - f(x_1)}{x_2 - x_1}$$

$\frac{y_2 - y_1}{x_2 - x_1}$  slope of secant

##### (2) Instantaneous Rate of Change

$$\text{Instantaneous Rate of Change} = \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{f(a+h) - f(a)}{h}$$

slope of tangent

**Example #1:** Consider the trigonometric function  $y = -3 \sin\left[\frac{1}{2}\left(x - \frac{\pi}{3}\right)\right]$ .

**Mapping Rule:**  $(x, y) \rightarrow \left(\frac{1}{2}x + \frac{\pi}{3}, -y\right)$

(a) Sketch one cycle of the function.

$(0, 0) \rightarrow (0, 0)$   
 $\left(\frac{\pi}{2}, 1\right) \rightarrow \left(\frac{\pi}{2}, -3\right)$   
 $(\pi, 0) \rightarrow (\pi, 0)$   
 $\left(\frac{3\pi}{2}, -1\right) \rightarrow \left(\frac{3\pi}{2}, 3\right)$   
 $(2\pi, 0) \rightarrow (2\pi, 0)$

(b) Determine an interval where the avg. rate of change is:

(i) positive  $x \in \left[\frac{4\pi}{3}, \frac{10\pi}{3}\right]$

(ii) negative  $x \in \left[\frac{\pi}{3}, \frac{4\pi}{3}\right]$

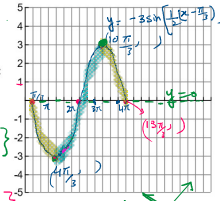
(iii) zero  $x \in \{4\pi\}$

(c) Determine a point where the inst. rate of change is:

(i) positive  $x = \frac{5\pi}{3}$

(ii) negative  $x = \frac{2\pi}{3}$

(iii) zero  $x \in \{4\pi\}$



(d) Calculate the average rate of change for  $\frac{\pi}{2} \leq x \leq \frac{3\pi}{2}$ .

$$\begin{aligned} \text{AROC} &= \frac{f\left(\frac{3\pi}{2}\right) - f\left(\frac{\pi}{2}\right)}{\frac{3\pi}{2} - \frac{\pi}{2}} \\ &= \frac{-2.898 + 0.776}{\pi} \\ &= -0.675 \end{aligned}$$

(e) Describe how the instantaneous rate of change varies over the interval  $[0, 4\pi]$ .

The IROC decreases, increases, decreases.  
 The IROC is zero at max and min

**Example #1:** Consider the trigonometric function  $y = -3 \sin\left[\frac{1}{2}\left(x - \frac{\pi}{3}\right)\right]$  + 0 page - 37

$$a = -3$$

$$|a| = 3$$

$$k = \frac{1}{2}$$

$$P = \frac{2\pi}{k}$$

$$P = \frac{2\pi}{1/2} = 4\pi$$

$$P = 4\pi$$

$C = y = 0$  (No v.d)  
 Phase shift  $= \frac{\pi}{3}$  (right)

$$\text{max} = |a| + C$$

$$= 3 + 0$$

$$\text{max} = 3$$

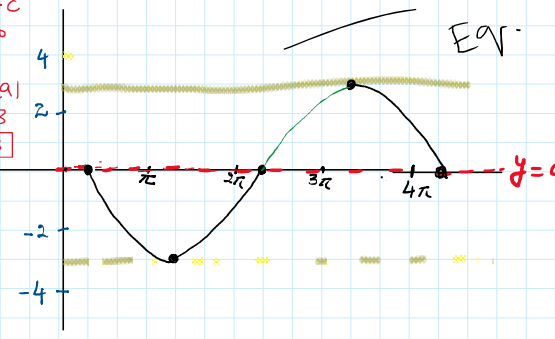
$$\text{min} = C - |a|$$

$$= 0 - 3$$

$$\text{min} = -3$$

reflected across x-axis

base function  $y = \sin \theta$



Eq.

**Example #2:** The position of a particle as it moves horizontally is described by the equation  $s(t) = 12\sin\left(\frac{\pi t}{90}\right) + 15$ , where  $s$  is the displacement, in metres, and  $t$  is the time, in seconds.

(a) Calculate the average rate of change of  $s(t)$  for the following intervals:

(i) 5 s to 10 s

$$\begin{aligned} \text{A.R.O.C} &= \frac{s(10) - s(5)}{10 - 5} \\ &= \frac{19.10424172 - 17.08377813}{5} \\ &= \frac{2.020463588}{5} \\ &= 0.404 \text{ m/s} \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} s(10) &= 12\sin\left(\frac{10\pi}{90}\right) + 15 \\ &= 19.10424172 \\ s(5) &= 12\sin\left(\frac{5\pi}{90}\right) + 15 \\ &= 17.08377813 \end{aligned}$$

(ii) 9 s to 10 s

$$\begin{aligned} \text{A.R.O.C} &= \frac{s(10) - s(9)}{10 - 9} \\ &= \frac{19.10424172 - 18.70820393}{1} \\ &= 0.396 \text{ m/s} \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} s(10) &= 12\sin\left(\frac{10\pi}{90}\right) + 15 \\ &= 19.10424172 \\ s(9) &= 12\sin\left(\frac{9\pi}{90}\right) + 15 \\ &= 18.70820393 \end{aligned}$$

(b) Estimate the instantaneous rate of change of  $s(t)$  at  $t = 10$ s.

$$\begin{aligned} \text{I.R.O.C} &= \frac{f(10 + 0.001) - f(10)}{0.001} \\ &= \frac{f(10.001) - f(10)}{0.001} \\ &= \frac{19.10463533 - 19.10424172}{0.001} \\ &= 0.394 \text{ m/s} \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} s(t) &= 12\sin\left(\frac{\pi t}{90}\right) + 15 \\ s(10.001) &= 12\sin\left[\frac{10.001\pi}{90}\right] + 15 \\ &= 19.10463533 \\ s(10) &= 12\sin\left(\frac{10\pi}{90}\right) + 15 \\ &= 19.10424172 \end{aligned}$$

(c) What physical quantity does this instantaneous rate of change represent?

**It represent the instantaneous velocity at 10 seconds**